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STORY PROOF

NAME	TAG	STATUS	SOURCE	TO RUN	DEPTH	LAST CHANGE
COMMEN. MCKENH. A0098R/	AM-OBJECT	ORIGNL	EUI	/ /	5.0 MCKENH	7/15/87

{sf2}AM-OBJECT{sf1}{ep}

BRITISH AIRLINER CREW BAFFLED BY OBJECT OVER SOVIET UNION {ep}

LONDON, June 27, Reuter - A British airline pilot told today how he had to take evasive action to avoid hitting a mystery object over the Soviet republic of Kazakhstan. {ep}

"It was definitely not an aircraft, of that I am positive. None of us had ever seen anything like it before," First Officer Anthony Colin, said in a letter published in the the Times of London. {ep}

The Times said the crew of five of a British Airways Jumbo Jet, on a flight from London to Bangkok in April, were baffled by the object with twinkling lights which flew directly toward them before disappearing at high speed over the horizon. {ep}

A BA spokesman said that Soviet air traffic control had confirmed that there were no other aircraft in the area at the time. {ep}

He suggested the most plausible explanation was that it was a piece of satellite re-entering the earth's atmosphere. {ep}

"Captains sometimes report seeing space debris," he explained. {ep}

"We are all bitter, cynical aviators who like to find a scientific explanation for everything. But this has got us foxed," Colin said. {ep}

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